Session 9: What is the Serial About?

- How does subject cataloging for serials differ from monographs?
- How many subject headings are appropriate?
- How do I go about assigning subject headings?
- How are serials classified?

1

Subject Headings

- Assign headings for the whole serial, not for a single issue
  - May need to review the general scope of the serial to be sure that headings are broad enough
- Typically 1-3 subject headings in standard records
- Most important subject comes first and relates to call number

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Subject Headings

• Assign more than one heading when there is more than one predominant topic

Example: South African review of books

650 -0 $a South African literature (English) $y 20th century $v Book reviews $v Periodicals.

651 -0 $a South Africa $v Book reviews $v Periodicals.

3

Strategies for Assigning Subjects

For title changes:

– Same subject headings as in the old title record

– Evaluate the headings:

Labor and laboring classes (no longer valid)
use:
Working class
Labor movement
and/or Labor

– Add new headings if scope has been expanded

4

Strategies for Assigning Subjects

- Look at the contents page, scope statements in a masthead, editorial commentary, instructions to authors, etc. for key words and phrases
- Search your OPAC
- Use significant words from the title

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Special Cases: Annual Reports, etc.

- When corporate body is subject, give in 610
- Give also a topical heading if report covers activities on a topic
  - 245 10 $a Annual report of the Library of Congress.
  - 610 20 $a Library of Congress $v Periodicals.
  - 650 0- $a Libraries $z United States $v Periodicals.

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Special Cases: Place Name in Title

- Use a geographical heading or subdivision if the serial focuses on activities in that place
  - e.g., Seattle magazine is about Seattle and the Pacific Northwest

    651 -0 $a Seattle (Wash.) $v Periodicals

    651 -0 $a Pacific Northwest $v Periodicals
- Do not use the geographical heading if the place is just that of publication and the scope is broader
  - e.g., *New England journal of medicine* is not limited to medicine in New England

    650 -0 $a Medicine $v Periodicals.

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Form Subdivisions

$v Periodicals (most common)

$v Catalogs
$v Congresses
$v Directories
$v Indexes

Subfield “v” is used to denote the form of the resource being cataloged.

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Form Subdivisions

Examples:

Title: *Guide to religious and inspirational magazines*

650 -0 $a Religion $x Periodicals $v Bibliography $v Periodicals.

Title: *International Labour Office. Periodicals abstracted in International labour documentation in ...*

650 -0 $a Labor $x Periodicals $v Bibliography $v Periodicals.

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Form Subdivisions

- Newspapers:

651 -0 $a Chicago (Ill.) $v Newspapers.
651 -0 $a Boston (Mass.) $v Newspapers.

- U.S. ethnic newspapers:

650 -0 $a African Americans $z Massachusetts $z Boston $v Newspapers.

650 -0 $a Greeks $z Illinois $z Chicago $v Newspapers.

650 -0 $a Armenians $z United States $v Newspapers.

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LC Classification

Record 1 (English title):
650 -0 $a Technology
$v Periodicals.

T1-995 Technology (General) [H R B L D S]
T1-4 Periodicals and societies. By language of publication
T1 English [H R B L D S]
T2 French [H R B L D S]
T3 German [H R B L D S]
T4 Other languages (not A-Z) [H R B L D S]
(T5) Yearbooks [H R B L D S]
see T1-4
T6 Congresses [H R B L D S]
Industrial museums, etc. see T179-183 [H R]
International exhibitions see T391-995 [H R]
T7 Collected works (nonserial) [H R B L D S]

T1

T3

Record 2 (German title):
650 -0 $a Technology $v Periodicals.

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LC Classification

Record 1: T12.3.C18
651 -0 $a California $x Industry $v Directories.

T11.95-12 Industrial directories [H R B L D S]
T11.95 General works [H R B L D S]
T12-12.5 By region or country [H R B L D S]
T12-12.3 United States [H R B L D S]
T12 General works [H R B L D S]
T12.3.A-Z By region or state, A-Z [H R B L D S]
Subarrange each country by Table T4a
T12.5.A-Z Other regions or countries, A-Z [H R B L D S]

Record 2: T12.5.V4
651 -0 $a Venezuela $x Industry $v Directories.

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LC Classification

Example: T14.7

650 -0 $a Technology $x History $v Periodicals.

T14.7-33 History [H R B L D S]
Including the history of inventions

T14.7 Periodicals, societies, serials, etc. [H R B L D S]

T15 General works [H R B L D S]

T16 Ancient [H R B L D S]

T17 Medieval [H R B L D S]

T18 Modern [H R B L D S]

T19 19th-20th centuries [H R B L D S]

T20 20th century [H R B L D S]
Including "technological wonders of the modern world"

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LC Classification

In some cases, the schedules require assigning a second cutter after a generic serial cutter:

Example: T57.6.A1

650 -0 $a Technology $x Research $v Periodicals

T57.6-.97 Operations research. Systems analysis [H R B L D S]
Cf. QA402-402.37 Analytical methods connected with physical problems

T57.6.A1 Periodicals, societies, etc. [H R B L D S]

T57.6.A2-Z General works [H R B L D S]

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Cuttering Serials

- Successive work letters for corporate main entry:

RA997.U48a United States. Congress...
Nursing home care in the ...

RA997.U48b United States. Congress...
Annual report of the ...

- Successive Cutters for translations:

Z6723.U5 Military review (English original)
Z6723.U52 Military review (Portuguese ed.)
Z6723.U53 Military review (Spanish ed.)

- Otherwise, cutter by main entry (usually title)

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Summary

- Assign at least one subject heading unless subject is too general
- Assign headings to cover the scope of the whole serial, not any one issue
- Classification is usually based on the first subject heading
- Cutters are assigned based on the main entry

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